

NOV - 2 1943

Secretary Morgenthau

Randolph Paul

For your information

While you were away, there were some developments in connection with the proposal of the World Jewish Congress to evacuate Jewish refugees from Rumania and France, which we thought you would like to have.

On September 28th State despatched a cable (copy of which is attached) to Berne in which the Treasury authorized the Minister at Berne to issue an appropriate license to the World Jewish Congress and its agents to undertake the transactions necessary for the evacuation program, under specified safeguards designed to prevent any benefit to the enemy. In reply, a cable dated October 6th (copy of which is attached) was received from our Minister at Berne, requesting specific instructions from State before acting on the authority granted by the Treasury, and pointing out that, in accordance with standing instructions concerning trading with the enemy problems, the matter had been discussed with the British who opposed the issuance of the license.

Although this cable from Berne was dated October 6th, Treasury heard nothing of it until October 18th when it was informally called to our attention by people in Governor Lehman's office and the Blockade and Supply Division of State. Treasury prodded State for a copy ~~of the cable~~ and finally received it on October 20th at 5:15 p.m.

We drafted a reply (copy of which is attached) instructing Berne to issue the license in question to the World Jewish Congress and its agents. This draft was sent to State at 9:15 a.m. October 23rd. Pehle at the same time advised Stone of Secretary Hull's office that the reply which Treasury would like to see made had been sent to State and, in view of the long delay which had already occurred, Pehle requested that this reply be despatched promptly. On October 26th we

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